HISTORY (5E, 2024 RULES) – DESCRIPTION

History is an **Intelligence** skill. It is used to recall **historical events** and **figures**, **ancient civilizations**, **wars**, and certain creatures (Giants and Humanoids). The DM asks for a roll when the knowledge is **uncertain** and **interesting**.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. You take the **Study** action: an **Intelligence (History)** check, consulting your memory, a book, or a clue.
2. The **DM sets the DC** using the official scale: 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30.
3. History covers **Giants** and **Humanoids**; other creature types fall under other skills.
4. On an ability check, a **20** or a **1** has no special effect: no critical here.
5. A History check often leads to another (**Tables** page).

Example: Mira (Intelligence +3, Proficiency +2) examines a tattered banner (DC 15). She rolls 10 + 3 + 2 = 15: she recognizes the arms of a kingdom lost to war.

⚠ Using another ability:

- The ability of a check is **decided by the situation**: the DM may pair History with **Wisdom** (learning from the past), **Charisma** (telling a tale to an assembly), or **Constitution** (sifting archives all night). Table rule
- The **Proficiency Bonus** applies when the skill **fits** and you are proficient.
- See the **Use cases** page.

⚠ Change from 2014

The **Study** action is new: History is a domain there (events, civilizations, wars) and covers **Giants** and **Humanoids**. In 2014, the skill wasn't tied to any creature type.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

No official DC, and the line with **Arcana**, **Religion**, and **Nature** is debated. Fix: the **DM announces** the skill and the DC **before** the roll, and allows **one roll per subject**.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

Describe the **memory**: a date learned as a child, a battle song, a king's name carved in stone.

Step 1 – Decide whether a roll is needed:

A roll happens only if the knowledge is **uncertain** and **interesting**. A fact known to all is given with no roll.

Step 2 – Take the Study action:

You consult your memory, a book, or a clue: an **Intelligence** (**History**) check. It is an **action**, which matters mostly in combat.

Step 3 – Set the DC: Table rule

The knowledge is...	DC
Very common	5
Common	10
Specialized	15
Rare	20
Very rare or secret	25
Legendary or forgotten	30

The 5-to-30 scale is official; how knowledge is ranked is a table suggestion, to adapt.

Step 4 – Make the roll:

d20 + Intelligence modifier + **Proficiency Bonus** if you are proficient in History. An ally can use the **Help** action to give you **Advantage**.

Step 5 – Resolve and chain:

- **Total ≥ DC**: you remember. The higher the total, the more you know. Table rule
- **Total < DC**: you recall nothing useful (or an incomplete memory, per the table). Table rule
- A 20 or a 1 on the d20 **changes nothing** on an ability check.

History uses in the 2024 rules:

Situation	Check and DC
Recall historical events and figures	Study: Intelligence (History), DC set by the DM
Recall ancient civilizations and wars	Study: Intelligence (History), DC set by the DM
Recall certain creatures (Giants and Humanoids)	Study: Intelligence (History), DC set by the DM

When one use case leads to another:

First check	Consequence	Next use case
Study: creature (Giant, Humanoid)	Success: you remember	Trait table (Creature Lore sheet)
Study: ruin or relic	You know who built it	Study (Arcana or Religion) for its symbols
Study: origin of an item	You know its history	Identification of its real power (Magic Items sheet)
Study: a noble's lineage	You know allies and rivals	Influence: tailored arguments (Persuasion, Intimidation)
Study: a past war	You know its causes	Clue about a trap or local legend

Chain example: Mira recognizes a giants' ossuary (Study, History, DC 15: 14 + 3 + 2 = 19). She learns these giants feared fire. The DM then gives her two traits from the table (Creature Lore).

Ability + skill combinations: Table rule

*The DM decides the ability by the situation and applies proficiency if it fits. These combinations are **exceptions announced before the roll**.*

Combination	Use in play
Wisdom (History)	Recognize that a situation repeats a pattern from the past and draw a lesson.
Charisma (History)	Tell a historical tale to an assembly to captivate or convince it.
Constitution (History)	Sift dusty archives all night without flagging.
Dexterity (History)	Handle an ancient manuscript or scroll without damaging it.

Neighboring skills:

Skill	Use in play
Intelligence (Persuasion)	Convince a court or a king with a logical argument built on precedents.
Intelligence (Investigation)	Cross-check archives and testimonies to date an event.
Intelligence (Religion)	Link a past conflict to a cult or a religious schism.

How to choose: Table rule

1. What does the task demand: **power, agility, endurance, mind, presence**? That gives the ability.
2. Which skill describes the **know-how**? Apply proficiency if it fits.
3. The DM **announces** the combination and the DC before the roll.

*Example: Brann (Charisma +3, History proficiency +2) tells the fall of a kingdom to villagers, DC 15. He rolls 12 + 3 + 2 = 17: success, the assembly listens. See also the **Athletics** sheet.*

Common table questions.

History, Arcana, Religion, or Nature?

History: events, figures, civilizations, wars, Giants and Humanoids. **Arcana**: magic and planes. **Religion**: deities, rites, holy symbols. **Nature**: terrain, flora, climate, and certain creatures (Beasts, Dragons...).

Does recalling something take an action?

Yes: **Study** is an action, which matters mostly in combat.

Does my character know the world's history?

It depends on the DC the DM sets and on your proficiency in the skill.

Can I retry Study on the same subject?

Table tip: **one roll per subject**, unless a new clue appears. Table rule

Does a failure give a false memory?

The rules don't say. Table option: an incomplete or mistaken memory, announced in advance by the DM. Table rule

Is a 20 an automatic success?

No: on an ability check, a **20** or a **1** has no special effect.

Does History apply to all creatures?

Only to Giants and Humanoids. See the **Creature Lore** sheet for other types.

Can I use History with another ability?

Yes: the ability is decided by the situation. See the **Use cases** page. Table rule

Which features help?

Expertise doubles the Proficiency Bonus. The Rogue can treat a 9 or lower as a 10. The **Help** action gives Advantage.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

20 and 1 on a check

On an ability check, a 20 or a 1 has no special effect: no Critical Hit, no automatic failure.

Check, attack and save

These are three distinct d20 rolls: a rule that affects one applies to the others only if it says so.

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